Organizational Behavior 15th Ed

Robbins and Judge

Chapter 3

Attitudes and Job Satisfaction

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Chapter 3 Learning Objectives

After studying this chapter you should be able to:

- **Contrast the three components of an attitude.**
- **Summarize the relationship between attitudes and behavior.**
- **Compare and contrast the major job attitudes.**
- **Define job satisfaction and show how it can be measured.**
- **Summarize the main causes of job satisfaction.**
- **Identify four employee responses to dissatisfaction.**

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LO 1

Contrast the Three Components of an Attitude

Evaluative statements or judgments concerning objects, people, or events

Three components of an attitude:

- Affective
- Cognitive
- Behavioral
- Attitude

The emotional or feeling segment of an attitude

The opinion or belief segment of an attitude

An intention to behave in a certain way toward someone or something

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LO 2

Summarize the Relationship Between Attitudes and Behavior

- The attitudes people hold determine what they do.
- Festinger proposed that cases of attitude following behavior illustrate the effects of cognitive dissonance.
  - Cognitive Dissonance is incompatibility an individual might perceive between two or more attitudes or between behavior and attitudes.
- Research has generally concluded that people seek consistency among their attitudes and between their attitudes and their behavior.

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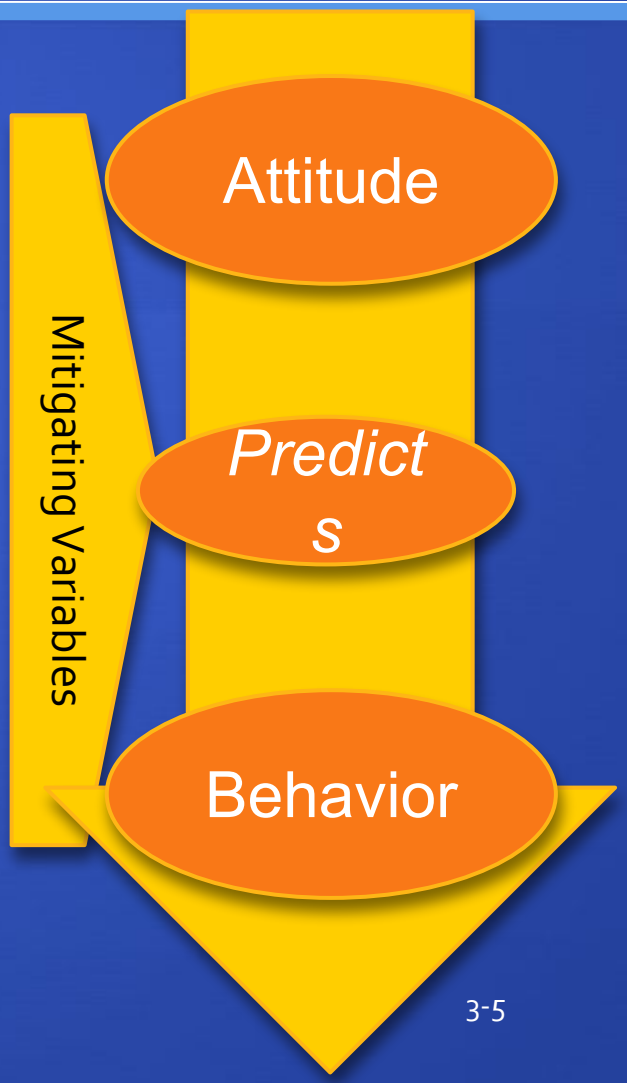
LO 2

Summarize the Relationship Between Attitudes and Behavior

- Importance of the attitude
- Its correspondence to behavior
- Its accessibility
- The presence of social pressure
- Whether or not a person has had direct experience with the behavior
- The attitude/behavior relationship is stronger if it refers to something in our direct personal experience



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LO 3

Compare and Contrast the Major Job Attitudes

- Job Satisfaction
  - A positive feeling about the job resulting from an evaluation of its characteristics
- Job Involvement
  - Degree of psychological identification with the job where perceived performance is important to self-worth
- Psychological Empowerment
  - Belief in the degree of influence over the job, competence, job meaningfulness, and autonomy

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LO 3

Compare and Contrast the Major Job Attitudes

- Organizational Commitment
  - Identifying with a particular organization and its goals, while wishing to maintain membership in the organization.
  - Three dimensions:
    - Affective – emotional attachment to organization
    - Continuance – economic value of staying
    - Normative – moral or ethical obligations

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LO 3

Compare and Contrast the Major Job Attitudes

- Organizational Commitment (cont)
  - Has some relation to performance, especially for new employees.
  - Theoretical models propose that employees who are committed will be less likely to engage in work withdrawal even if they are dissatisfied, because they have a sense of organizational loyalty.

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LO 3

Compare and Contrast the Major Job Attitudes

- Perceived Organizational Support (POS)
  - Degree to which employees believe the organization values their contribution and cares about their well-being.
  - Higher when rewards are fair, employees are involved in decision making, and supervisors are seen as supportive.
  - High POS is related to higher OCBs and performance.

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LO 3

Compare and Contrast the Major Job Attitudes

- **Employee Engagement**
  - **The degree of involvement with, satisfaction with, and enthusiasm for the job.**
  - **Engaged employees are passionate about their work and company.**

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LO 3

Compare and Contrast the Major Job Attitudes

- Are These Job Attitudes Really Distinct?
  - No: these attitudes are highly related
  - Variables may be redundant *(measuring the same thing under a different name)*
  - While there is some distinction, there is also a lot of overlap
  - Overlap may cause confusion

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LO 4

Define Job Satisfaction and Show How It Can Be Measured

- Job satisfaction
  - A positive feeling about a job resulting from an evaluation of its characteristics
- Two approaches for measuring Job Satisfaction are popular:
  - The single global rating
  - The summation of job facets

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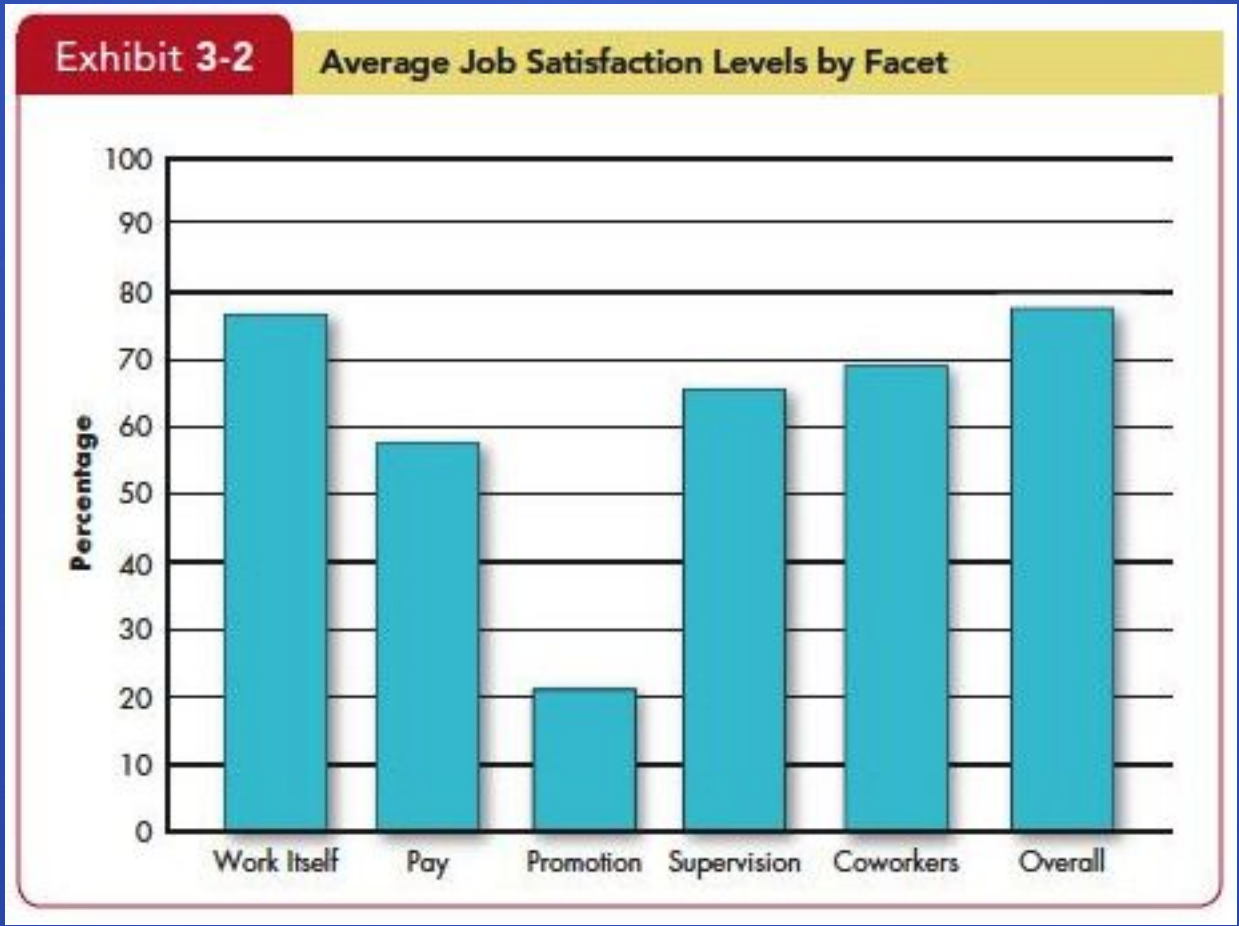
LO 4

Define Job Satisfaction and Show How It Can Be Measured



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LO 5

Summarize the Main Causes of Job Satisfaction

- Pay influences job satisfaction only to a point.
  - After about $40,000 per year (in the U.S.), there is no relationship between amount of pay and job satisfaction.
  - Money may bring happiness, but not necessarily job satisfaction.

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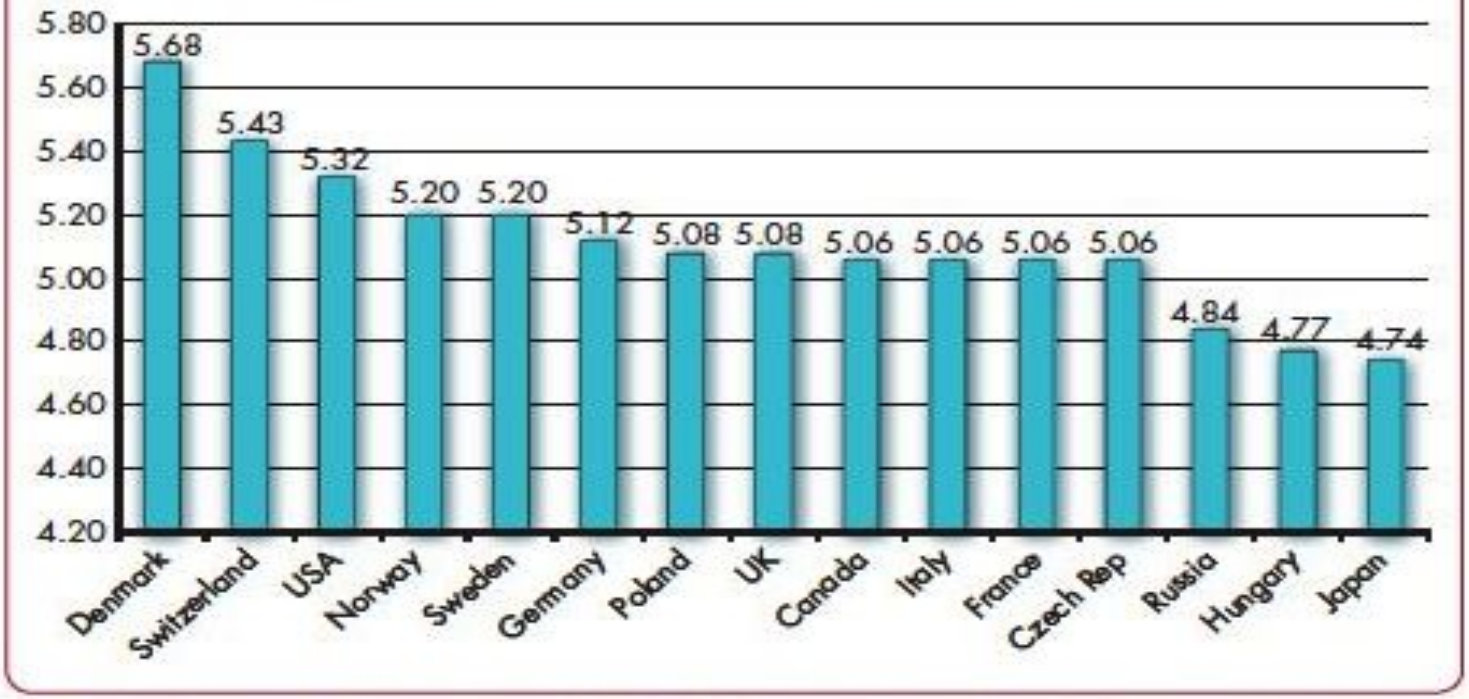
LO 5

Summarize the Main Causes of Job Satisfaction



Note: Scores represent average job-satisfaction levels in each country as rated on a 1 = very dissatisfied to 10 = very satisfied scale.

Source: M. Benz and B. S. Frey, "The Value of Autonomy: Evidence from the Self-Employed in 23 Countries," working paper 173, Institute for Empirical Research in Economics, University of Zurich, November 2003 (ssrn.com/abstract=475140).

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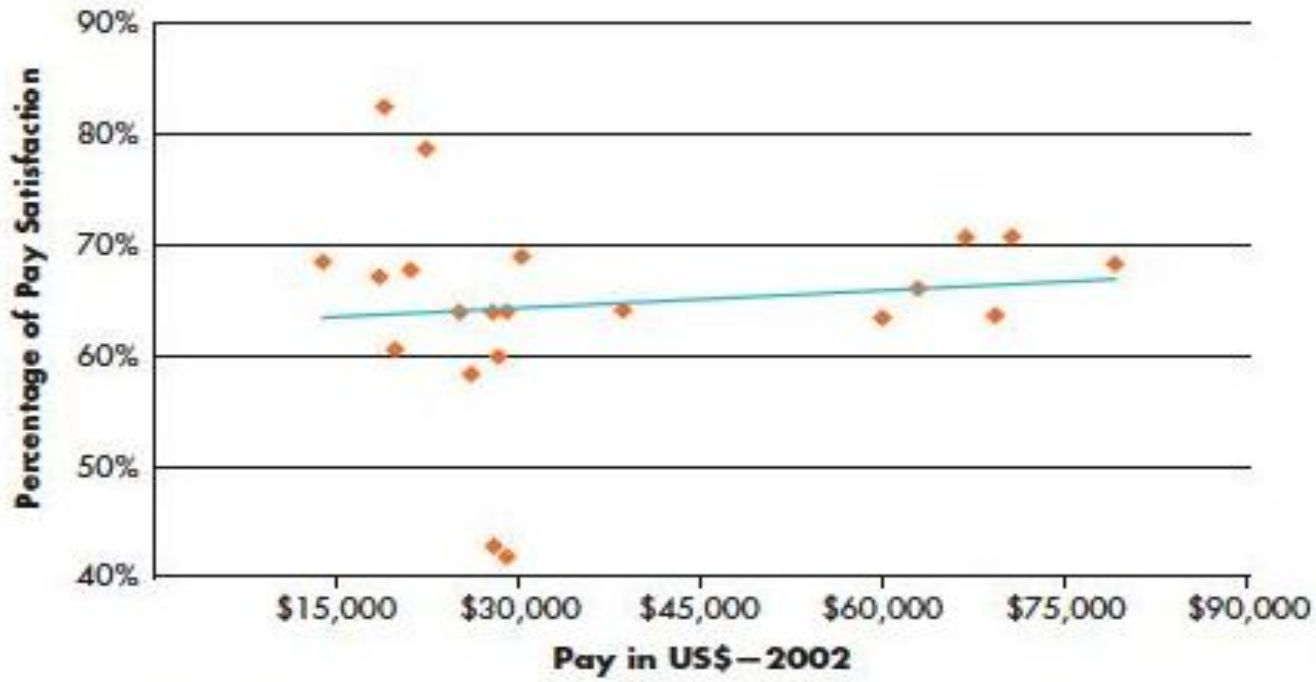
LO 5

Summarize the Main Causes of Job Satisfaction

Exhibit 3-4 Relationship Between Average Pay in Job and Job Satisfaction of Employees in That Job



Source: T. A. Judge, R. F. Piccolo, N. P. Podsakoff, J. C. Shaw, and B. L. Rich, "Can Happiness Be 'Earned'? The Relationship Between Pay and Job Satisfaction," working paper, University of Florida, 2005.

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LO 5

Summarize the Main Causes of Job Satisfaction

- Personality also plays a role in Job Satisfaction.
  - People who have positive core self-evaluations, who believe in their inner worth and basic competence are more satisfied with their jobs than those with negative core self-evaluations.
  - Those with negative core self-evaluations set less ambitious goals and are more likely to give up when confronting difficulties.

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LO 6

Identify Four Employee Responses to Dissatisfaction

Exhibit 3-5 Responses to Dissatisfaction

	Constructive	Destructive
Active	VOICE	EXIT
Passive	LOYALTY	NEGLECT

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Summary and Implications for Managers

- Satisfied and committed employees have lower rates of turnover, absenteeism, and withdrawal behaviors.
- Managers will also want to measure job attitudes effectively so they can tell how employees are reacting to their work.
- The most important thing managers can do to raise employee satisfaction is focus on the intrinsic parts of the job, such as making the work challenging and interesting.
- Although paying employees poorly will likely not attract high-quality employees to the organization or keep high performers, managers should realize that high pay alone is unlikely to create a satisfying work environment.

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